

Medical Nutrition Therapy

180.1 Links in PDF documents are not guaranteed to work. To follow a web link, please use the MCD Website.

Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

180.1

Manual Section Title

Medical Nutrition Therapy

Version Number

2

Effective Date of this Version

01/01/2022

Implementation Date

07/05/2022

Description Information

Benefit Category

Medical Nutrition Therapy Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

Section 1861(s)(2)(V) of the Social Security Act authorizes Medicare part B coverage of medical nutrition therapy services (MNT) for certain beneficiaries who have diabetes or a renal disease. Regulations for MNT were established on January 2, 2002, at 42 CFR 410.130 - 410.134. This national coverage determination (NCD) establishes the duration and frequency limits for the MNT benefit and coordinates MNT and diabetes outpatient self-management training (DSMT) as an NCD.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered

Effective January 1, 2022, basic coverage of MNT, for the first year a beneficiary receives MNT, with either a diagnosis of renal disease or diabetes as defined at [42 CFR 410.130](#) is three hours of administration. Basic coverage in subsequent years for renal disease or diabetes is two hours. The dietitian/nutritionist may choose how many units are administered per day as long as all of the other requirements in this NCD and [42 CFR 410.130-410.134](#) are met. Pursuant to the exception at [42 CFR 410.132\(b\)\(5\)](#), additional hours are considered to be medically necessary and covered if the physician determines that there is a change in medical condition, diagnosis, or treatment regimen that requires a change in MNT and orders additional hours during that episode of care.

If the physician determines that receipt of both MNT and DSMT is medically necessary in the same episode of care, Medicare will cover both DSMT and MNT initial and subsequent years without decreasing either benefit as long as DSMT and MNT are not provided on the same date of service. The dietitian/nutritionist may choose how many units are performed per day as long as all of the other requirements in the NCD and [42 CFR 410.130-410.134](#) are met. Pursuant to the exception at [42 CFR 410.132\(b\)\(5\)](#), additional hours are considered to be medically necessary and covered if the physician determines that there is a change in medical condition, diagnosis, or treatment regimen that requires a change in MNT and orders additional hours during that episode of care.

C. Nationally Non-Covered

N/A

D. Other

N/A

(This NCD last reviewed December 2021.)

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 11272 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) [↗](#)

[TN 11426 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) [↗](#)

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

11272

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/files/document/r11272NCD.pdf> [↗](#)

Revision History

08/2022 - Transmittal 11545 dated August 5, 2022, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11584, dated, August 31, 2022. ([TN 11584](#) [↗](#)) (CR12822)

08/2022 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to provide a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates to specific NCDs. ([TN 11545](#) [↗](#)) (CR12822)

06/2022 - Transmittal 11400, dated May 4, 2022, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11460, dated, June 17, 2022, to update NCD 90.2, NGS, spreadsheet to conform with changes in CR 12124, and change the implementation date for all business requirements except 12705.6 to 30 days from issuance of this correction. All other information remains the same. ([TN 11460](#)) (CR12705)

05/2022 - Transmittal 11272, dated February 18, 2022, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11426, dated, May 20, 2022 to revise chapter 32 of the IOM for Pub. 100-04. This correction does not make any revisions to the companion Pub. 100-02 or Pub. 100-03; all revisions are associated with Pub. 100-04. All other information remains the same. ([TN 11426](#)) (CR12613)

05/2022 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 11400](#)) (CR12705)

02/2022 - The purpose of this Omnibus change request is to make Medicare contractors aware of the updates to remove two National Determination NCDs, updates to the Medical Nutritional Therapy (MNT) policy and updates to the Pulmonary Rehabilitation (PR), Cardiac Rehabilitation (CR), and Intensive Cardiac Rehabilitation (ICR) resulting from changes specified in the calendar year 2022 Physician Fee Schedule (PFS) final rule published on November 19, 2021. ([TN 11272](#)) (CR12613)

01/2021 - Transmittal 10515, dated December 10, 2020, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 10566, dated, January 14, 2021 to remove FISS Reason Codes (RCs) 59041, 59042, 59209, and 59210 from the spreadsheet for NCD 160.18. All other information remains the same. ([TN 10566](#)) (CR12027)

12/2020 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at: <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html>, along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, longstanding NCD process. ([TN 10515](#)) (CR12027)

10/2020 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at: <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html>, along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to

NCDs will be included in subsequent quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, longstanding NCD process. ([TN 10432](#)) (CR12027)

02/2017 - This change request (CR) is the 10th maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to national coverage determinations (NCDs). These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates as follows: CR7818, CR8109, CR8197, CR8691, CR9087, CR9252, CR9540, CR9631, and CR9751, as well as in CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent, quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. ([TN 1792](#)) (CR9861)

11/2016 - This change request (CR) is the 9th maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to national coverage determinations (NCDs). The majority of the NCDs included are a result of feedback received from previous ICD-10 NCD CR7818, CR8109, CR8197, CR8691, CR9087, CR9252, CR9540, and CR9631. Some are the result of revisions required to other NCD-related CRs released separately.

Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent, quarterly releases as needed. No policy-related changes are included with these updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. ([TN 1753](#)) (CR9751)

08/2016 - This change request (CR) is the 9th maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to national coverage determinations (NCDs). The majority of the NCDs included are a result of feedback received from previous ICD-10 NCD CR7818, CR8109, CR8197, CR8691, CR9087, CR9252, CR9540, and CR9631. Some are the result of revisions required to other NCD-related CRs released separately.

Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent, quarterly releases as needed. No policy-related changes are included with these updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. ([TN 1708](#)) (CR9751)

12/2015 - This change request (CR) is the 3rd maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions/updates specific to national coverage determinations (NCDs). The majority of the NCDs included are a result of feedback received from previous ICD-10 NCD CR7818, CR8109, CR8197, CR8691, & CR9087. Some are the result of revisions required to other NCD-related CRs released separately that included ICD-10 coding. Implementation date: 01/04/2016 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1580](#)) (CR9252)

08/2015 - This change request (CR) is the 3rd maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions/updates specific to national coverage determinations (NCDs). The majority of the NCDs included are a result of feedback received from previous ICD-10 NCD CR7818, CR8109, CR8197, CR8691, & CR9087. Some are the result of revisions required to other

NCD-related CRs released separately that included ICD-10 coding.
These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 01/04/2016 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1537](#)) (CR 9252)

05/2014 - CMS translated the information for this policy from ICD-9-CM/PCS to ICD-10-CM/PCS according to HIPAA standard medical data code set requirements and updated any necessary and related coding infrastructure. These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 10/06/2014 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1388](#)) ([TN 1388](#)) (CR 8691)

03/2013 - CMS translated the information for this policy from ICD-9-CM/PCS to ICD-10-CM/PCS according to HIPAA standard medical data code set requirements and updated any necessary and related coding infrastructure. These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 10/07/2013 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1199](#)) ([TN 1199](#)) (CR 8197)

05/01/2002 - Defined duration and frequency of the MNT benefit and how MNT and DSMT benefits are coordinated. Effective and implementation dates 10/1/2002. ([TN 154](#)) (CR 2142)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Medical Nutrition Therapy Benefit for Diabetes & ESRD \(CAG-00097N\)](#)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Medical Nutrition Therapy	2	01/01/2022 - N/A	You are here
Medical Nutrition Therapy	1	10/01/2002 - 01/01/2022	View